

While I Figure This Out

A few minutes of supported independence while you read, write, or make a call.

For the grown-up

Choose one card with your child. Gather its supplies, stay available, and agree on when you will check in. Start with five minutes and adjust for this child and this day.

This kit can occupy attention. It does not replace supervision.

The two-minute setup

- 1 Pick** Let your child choose between two cards, not all eight.
- 2 Place** Stay where your child can find you. Keep supplies within reach.
- 3 Say** "I need a few minutes. You can show me NEED HELP anytime."
- 4 Return** Tell them when you will check in, then follow through.

Make this fit your child

Use a visual timer only if your child likes one. Skip writing, noise, movement, or pretend play if it is unpleasant today. Any card can be done beside you. If your child wants connection, try doing the first step together.

Pick one card for right now

You can stop, switch, or ask for help. There is no score.

MAKE

Build a tiny city

You need: Paper and a pencil

1. Draw three buildings.
2. Give each one a job.
3. Add a path between them.

FINISH: You are done when someone could follow your path.

Drawing feels hard? Use three boxes and lines.

FIND

Shape hunter

You need: Paper and a pencil

1. Choose a shape: circle, square, or triangle.
2. Find five examples in this room.
3. Draw or write what you found.

FINISH: You are done after five finds.

Stay in the room your grown-up chose.

Pick one card for right now

You can stop, switch, or ask for help. There is no score.

MAKE

Three-box comic

You need: Paper and a pencil

1. Draw three boxes.
2. Show a character with a problem.
3. Show one thing they try next.

FINISH: You are done after three boxes.

Stick figures and words both count.

THINK

Sort, then switch

You need: Six safe objects near you

1. Put the objects into two groups.
2. Make up a name for each group.
3. Sort them again using a different rule.

FINISH: You are done after two different sorts.

Ask before moving anything fragile or important.

Pick one card for right now

You can stop, switch, or ask for help. There is no score.

MOVE

Quiet movement path

You need: A clear floor space

1. Pick a start and finish spot.
2. Walk there in three different ways.
3. Choose your favorite way and do it once more.

FINISH: You are done after four trips.

Keep your feet on the floor. No climbing.

REST

Make a pause spot

You need: A book or paper; optional cushion

1. Choose a comfortable place near your grown-up.
2. Sit, lie down, or change position.
3. Look at a book or draw for a little while.

FINISH: You are done when you want a new choice.

Resting counts, even if you are not still.

Pick one card for right now

You can stop, switch, or ask for help. There is no score.

THINK

Invent a code

You need: Paper and a pencil

1. Choose three symbols.
2. Give each symbol a word or sound.
3. Write a secret message using your code.

FINISH: You are done when your message is ready.

Show someone later, or keep it private.

FIND

One-page remix

You need: A book you already have

1. Open to any page.
2. Find one thing you notice.
3. Draw a different ending or new detail.

FINISH: You are done when your new idea is on paper.

Looking at pictures counts as reading.

Show me what you need

Point to a box, say the words, or hold up this page.

I AM STILL BUSY

Please check on me when you said you would.

I NEED HELP

Please pause when you can and come to me.

I WANT TO SWITCH

This card is not working for me. Let me choose again.

I AM DONE

I finished. What can I do next?

Grown-up note: "Need help" is always allowed. If your child needs you now, the task can wait.